

Chapter 157-3

But Father Zhao said: "Zhao Xuning, don't forget—when it comes to your major and marriage, you only have one choice."

"I remember." Zhao Xuning said. "But I don't want to get married."

"It's not up to you!" Father Zhao said. "You were bewitched by that woman. She's even two years older than you—what's so good about her?"

Zhao Xuning paused: "You don't need to know."

Her voice was very cold. She subconsciously raised her hand to adjust her glasses, but forgot that she wasn't wearing them today, and could only awkwardly withdraw her hand.

Father Zhao was so angry he choked for a moment, then said sternly: "Then what do you want?"

"To not marry." Zhao Xuning said. "From now on, you don't need to worry about me. I won't marry for an alliance."

Hearing this, Father Zhao stared at her in astonishment. "Zhao Xuning! Have I given you too much freedom these years?!"

Zhao Xuning lowered her gaze and nodded at him. "This has nothing to do with freedom."

"Then come back to the company!" Father Zhao said.

Zhao Xuning looked at him, pursed her lips, and suddenly said coldly: "Dad, I'm an adult now."

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The study of the Zhao family was as tense as ever, and it was difficult for Zhao Xuning to emerge from such an atmosphere unscathed.

In the end, it was her sister who mediated.

After leaving the house, Zhao Xuning got into the car. She had just fastened her seatbelt when the passenger door was opened and her sister got in. While fastening her seatbelt, her sister asked: "Are you still in contact with Shen Hui?"

Zhao Xuning paused: "Occasionally."

They only ran into each other in some very coincidental circumstances, and the atmosphere between them was even more tense than when she had been arguing with her father in the study just now.

There had been no private contact at all.

A few days ago, she'd heard that Shen Hui was going on blind dates with Yan Lin, though she didn't know if it had worked out.

At the mention of Shen Hui, Zhao Xuning's thoughts drifted a little. It was her sister's voice that pulled her back: "Is it that it has to be her for the rest of your life?"

Zhao Xuning: "..."

The car drove away from the Zhao residence and pulled over at an intersection.

Zhao Xuning's hand was still on the steering wheel. She curled her fingers and tapped lightly, then said with a bitter smile: "Not really."

"Then why won't you accept Father's suggestion?" Her sister said. "Ningning, you should know that compared to the Shen family, we're still a bit lacking."

"I know." Zhao Xuning said. "But if Shen Hui and I were together, I wouldn't care about any of that. Whether our future child takes the surname Shen or Zhao, whatever she wants—I'd be fine with it all. But..."

At this point, Zhao Xuning suddenly stopped. She covered her forehead with one hand, realizing that she had impulsively said a lot of things that didn't make logical sense.

She closed her eyes and took a deep breath. "Sorry, sis."

"It's fine." Her sister said. "Actually, I just came to ask you—what exactly do you want? So I can know how to handle things."

The car fell silent for a long time.

Zhao Xuning spoke softly: "I've never deliberately been waiting for Shen Hui. I know we can't go back to how we were. I brought her too much pain. I've been trying to move forward, but after trying for so long, I realized I've just been running in place."

Zhao Xuning felt powerless against this feeling too.

A deep sense of helplessness enveloped her, preventing her from thinking about these things. If she thought about them on some lonely late night, she would definitely drink until the early hours of the morning.

Her life had become extremely dismal, like she had returned to the time right after breaking up with Shen Hui.

She had always thought that after breaking up with Shen Hui, she had been moving forward, constantly moving forward.

But she hadn't expected that she had been walking in circles all along.

Round and round, always ending up at the starting point.

"So you're waiting for her?" Her sister asked tentatively.

Zhao Xuning shook her head.

Zhao Xuning's sister was also someone who leaned toward rational thinking, so she didn't quite understand Zhao Xuning's current state. She sat there thinking for a few seconds before asking again: "Then what exactly do you want?"

Zhao Xuning paused.

After a long while, she let out a deep sigh: "I don't know."